PROactive
ACCENT REDUCTION

Syllabic N Words

A syllabic consonant occurs when a consonant takes over and acts as the entire syllable itself; it takes over the vowel before it. The most common form of this is when an "L" or "N" becomes syllabic in unstressed syllables. The consonant does not sound any different than usual; it just allows you to delete the vowel before it altogether.

Syllabic "N":

appreciation	"uh-pree-she-ehee-shn"
burden	"bur-dn"
couldn't	"could-nt"
definitely	"def-nit-lee"
didn't	"di-dnt"
even	"e-vn"
fasten	"fa-sn"
happen	"ha-pn"
listen	"li-sn"
olden	"ohwl-dn"
often	"ah-fn"
reason	"ree-zn"
recreation	"reh-cree-ehee-shn"
relationship	"ruh-lay-shn-ship"
risen	"rih-zn"
sadden	"saa-dn"
second	"seh-knd"
shouldn't	"should-nt"
student	"stew-dnt"
tighten	"tie-tn"
wouldn't	"wood-nt"